A Free Music Festival Will Warm Up College Football's Big Game

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College football's biggest game is getting a musical warm-up, and it will not cost fans a cent. The free AT&T Playoff Playlist Live festival will take place on January 23-24 in Las Vegas, just before the 2027 College Football Playoff National **Championship** on January 25.

The **championship** game will see two top teams compete at Allegiant Stadium. First, a heavy-hitting **lineup** of DJs will provide the pump-up music at the festival, held at Las Vegas' Grand Prix Plaza, just off the Strip. The two-day festival is called AT&T Playoff Playlist Live, the CFP Music Festival. Doors open at 3 p.m. on both days.

Night one brings David Guetta, Marshmello, Alison Wonderland, Honeyluv, and Girl Math, the duo made up of Nala and VNSSA. Day two features John Summit, Fisher, Sofi Tukker, Korolova, and DJ Skilah. All of them are DJs and electronic music stars.

"No city embraces the variety of music **genres** like Las Vegas," said Ryan Allen Hall, the College Football Playoff's senior director of public events and sponsorships. "But it's clear, electronic music is the pulse." Las Vegas, he said, "simply does **EDM** like only a select few in the entire world."

The best part, Hall said, is the price. "The magic for us is to bring together this **stacked lineup** in Las Vegas and to charge the fans absolutely nothing," he said. The free concerts are part of the **championship**'s promise to give fans a world-class experience during National **Championship** week.

Last year's festival took place in Miami Beach, with John Summit, Calvin Harris, Peso Pluma, and Latin Mafia performing for a crowd of about 50,000. It was the largest concert ever seen on South Beach, Hall said. This year, the organizers say they are here to do the same for Las Vegas.

Word Treasure

championship -- The final game that decides the winner of a competition.
lineup -- The list of performers at a show.
genres -- Different kinds of music, like pop, rock, or electronic.
EDM -- Electronic dance music, music made with computers for dancing.
stacked -- Full of great performers, one after another.

Background you need

American football is a team sport played in the United States, and the College Football Playoff decides the national champion.

A music festival is a big outdoor event where many performers play music over one or more days.

A DJ is a person who plays recorded music for a crowd, often mixing songs together.

Las Vegas is a city in Nevada known for its bright lights, shows, and casinos.

Break it down

LEAD: A free music festival will warm up Las Vegas before college football's big game.
KEY EVENT: The AT&T Playoff Playlist Live festival takes place on January 23-24.
+- WHO: DJs like David Guetta, Marshmello, and John Summit
+- WHEN: January 23-24, before the championship on January 25
+- WHERE: Grand Prix Plaza in Las Vegas
EVIDENCE: Doors open at 3 p.m. both days; last year in Miami Beach drew about 50,000 people.
OPEN QUESTION: Which two teams will play in the championship game?

Why it matters

Big games are about more than the game itself: they bring music, fans, and whole cities together. A free festival means everyone can join the fun, not just people with tickets.

Test what you remember

1. When is the festival?

- (A) January 25
- (B) January 23-24
- (C) Last summer
- (D) This weekend

2. Where is the festival?

- (A) At Allegiant Stadium
- (B) In Miami Beach
- (C) At the Grand Prix Plaza in Las Vegas
- (D) In New York

3. Who plays on night one?

- (A) Taylor Swift
- (B) John Summit and Fisher
- (C) Calvin Harris and Peso Pluma
- (D) David Guetta, Marshmello, Alison Wonderland, Honeyluv, and Girl Math

4. How much do the concerts cost?

- (A) 50 dollars
- (B) Nothing, they are free
- (C) 100 dollars
- (D) 25 dollars

5. What did last year's festival in Miami Beach draw?

- (A) About 5,000 people
- (B) About 500,000 people
- (C) About 500 people
- (D) About 50,000 people

6. What time do doors open?

- (A) Noon
- (B) Midnight
- (C) 7 p.m.
- (D) 3 p.m.

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: D 4: B 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Ryan Allen Hall: He said Las Vegas does electronic music like only a few places in the world, and that charging fans nothing is the magic of the festival.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):